

WEEK 3: ASSIGNMENT REPORT

PROJECT OBJECTIVES

- **Algorithm Mastery:** To implement complex sorting methodologies (Merge Sort, Quick Sort, Heap Sort) without using standard/built-in high-level library functions.
- **Time & Space Efficiency:** To understand practical execution differences when dealing with scale boundaries ($N \leq 100,000$ elements).
- **Real-World Data Processing:** Applying mathematical constraints like average filtration, median identification, and percentile performance over unsorted telemetry data.

Primary Topic	Assignment Code & Problem Statement	Complexity Level	Primary Technical Competency Explored
Topic 1: Merge Sort	Question 1: Annual Placement Packages Sorting	Easy	Divide and Conquer Strategy, Recursive Splitting, $O(N \log N)$ Efficiency
	Question 2: Commerce Operational Processing Times	Medium	Statistical Analysis, Median Calculations, Handling Voluminous Datasets
Topic 2: Quick Sort	Question 1: Cloud Infrastructure Server Latency Sorting	Easy	Pivot Selection, In-Place Partitioning, Memory-Efficient Sorting
	Question 2: Financial Stock Market Trade-Value Analytics	Medium	Descending Order Inversion, Top-K Metric Analysis, Deviation from Averages
Topic 3: Heap Sort	Question 1: Online Gaming Tournament Leaderboard	Easy	Binary Tree Representation, Max-Heap Creation, Guaranteed Worst-Case Time Boundary
	Question 2: Multi-Specialty Hospital Emergency Services	Medium	Priority Queue Concepts, Complete Binary Tree Extraction, Percentage-Based Quality Metrics

Week 3

Sorting Algorithms

Topic 1: Merge Sort

Question 1 (Easy): University Placement Data Sorting

Problem - The college placement team collected salary data from students, but it is unorganized because entries were made randomly as received. We need to sort them in ascending order.

Why Merge Sort - Since the data can grow up to thousand of students ($N \leq 100,000$), simple algorithms like Bubble sort will become very slow. Merge sort handles large data efficiently with a guaranteed time complexity of $O(N \log N)$.

How does it work - It uses a Divide and Conquer approach. It splits the array of packages into two halves, recursively sorts them, and then merges them back together in a sorted manner.

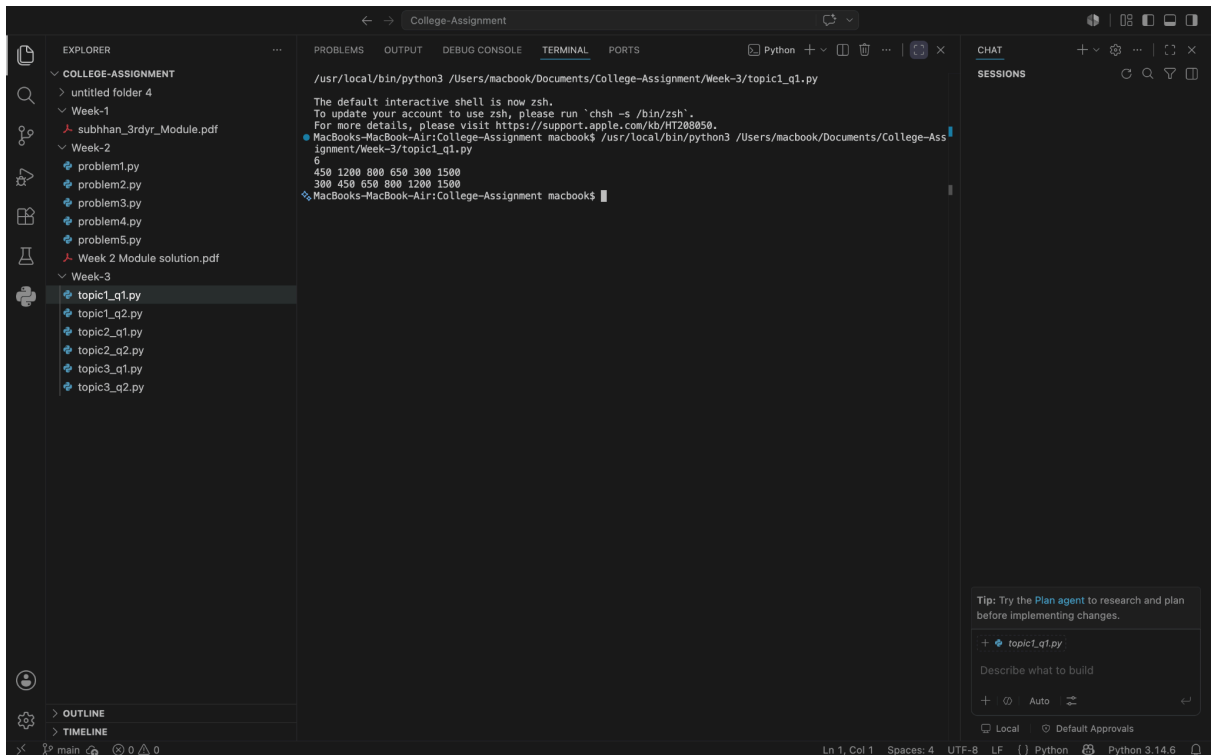
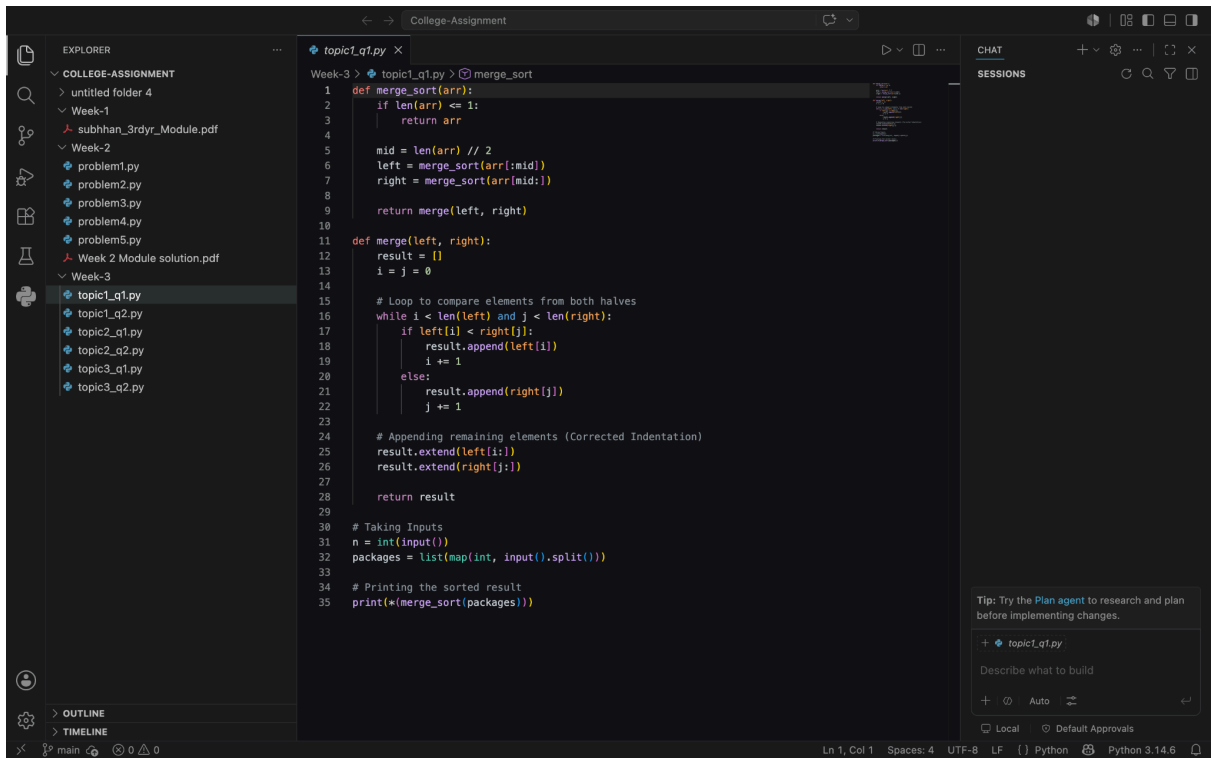
Code Reference - topic1-q1.py

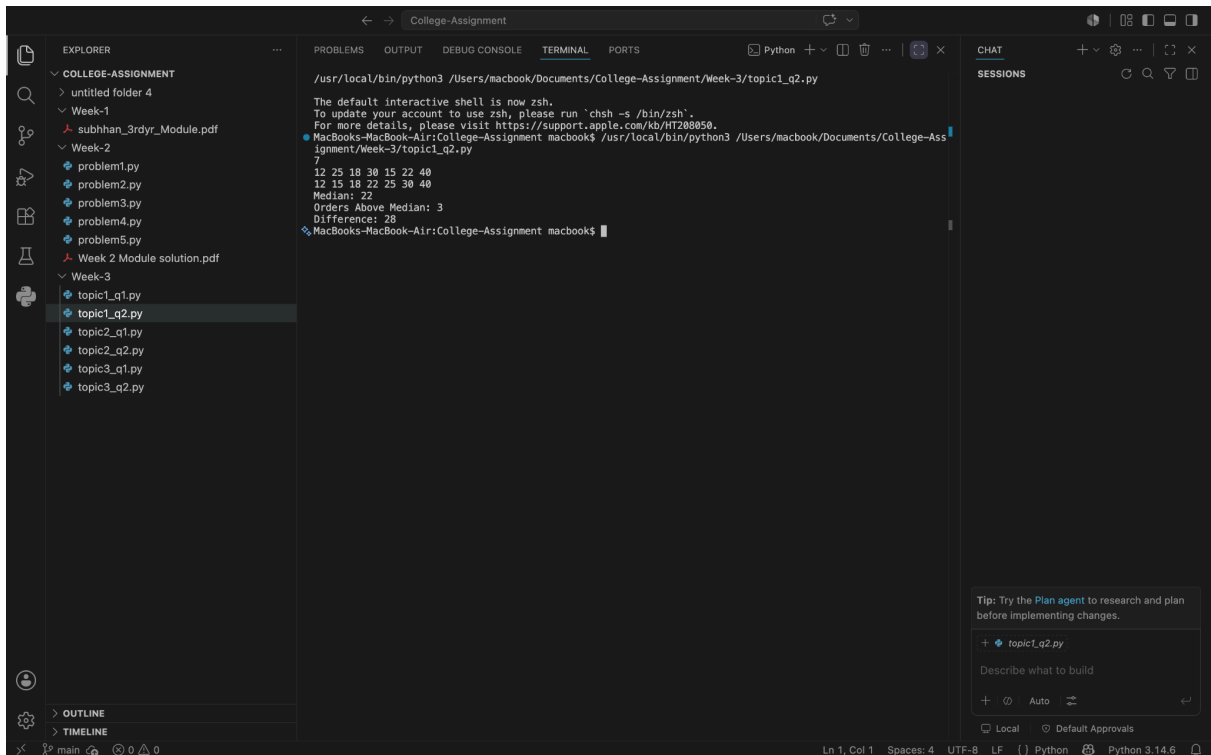
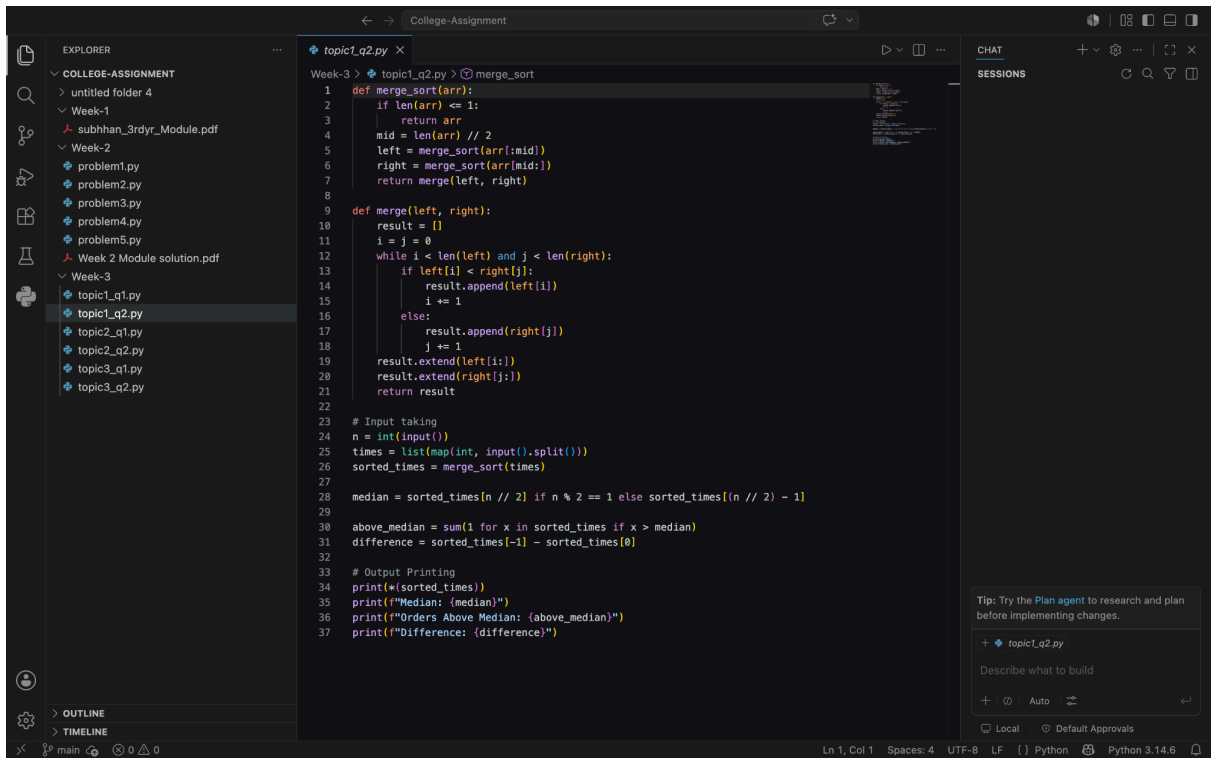
Question 2 (Medium): E-commerce Order processing Times

Problem - We need to sort warehouse processing times to study operational efficiency and calculate metrics like median, order above median, and the time difference between fastest / slowest orders.

Tricky part (Median and Condition) - Finding the median depends on whether N is odd or even. After sorting, if N is odd, the middle element is the median. If N is even, we pick the element at $(n/2) - 1$ as per the standard question logic. To find orders above the median, we loop through the sorted list and count elements strictly greater than it.

Code Reference - topic1-q2.py





Topic 2 - Quick Sort

Question 1 (Easy): Server Response Time sorting

Problem - A cloud company wants to arrange server latency times from fastest to slowest (ascending order) to find lagging server without using any built-in function.

Why Quick sort - Quick sort is an in-place sorting algorithm, meaning it does not require extra memory / arrays like Merge sort, making it highly memory efficient.

How does it work - It picks a middle element as a 'Pivot'. Then, it divides the remaining elements into three groups: items smaller than pivot (left), items equal to pivot (middle), and items larger than pivot (right). It repeats this recursively.

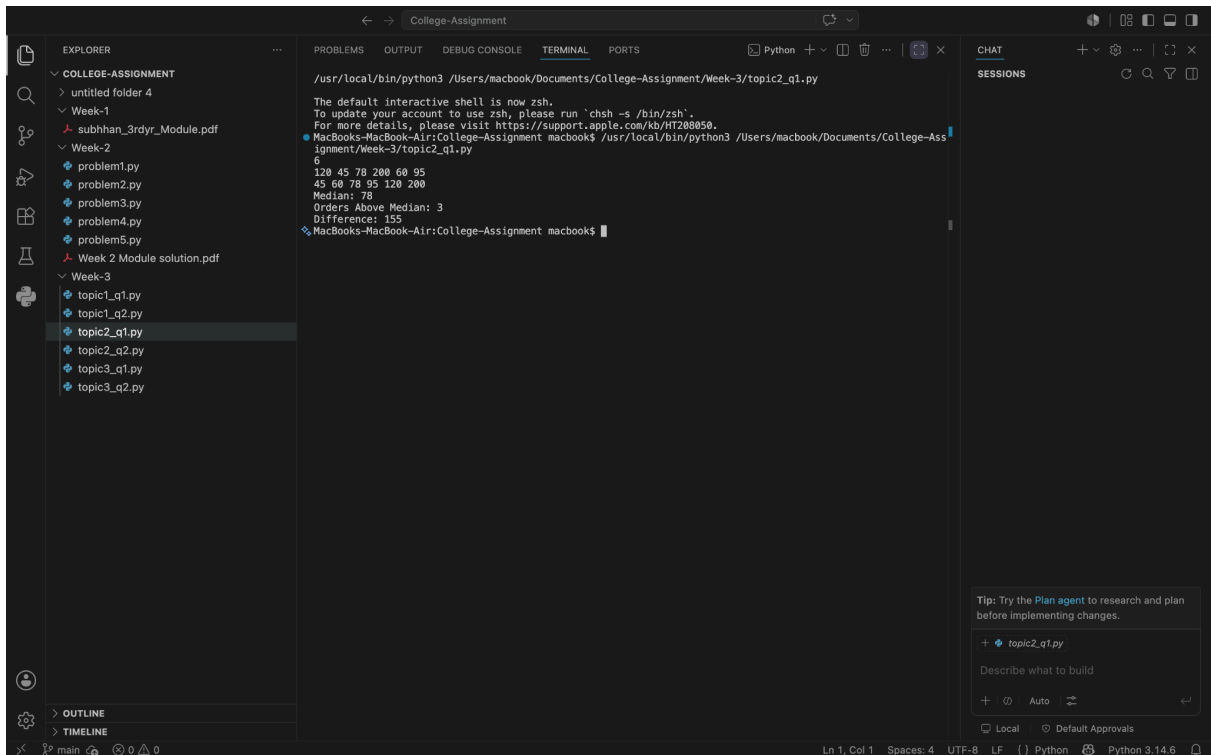
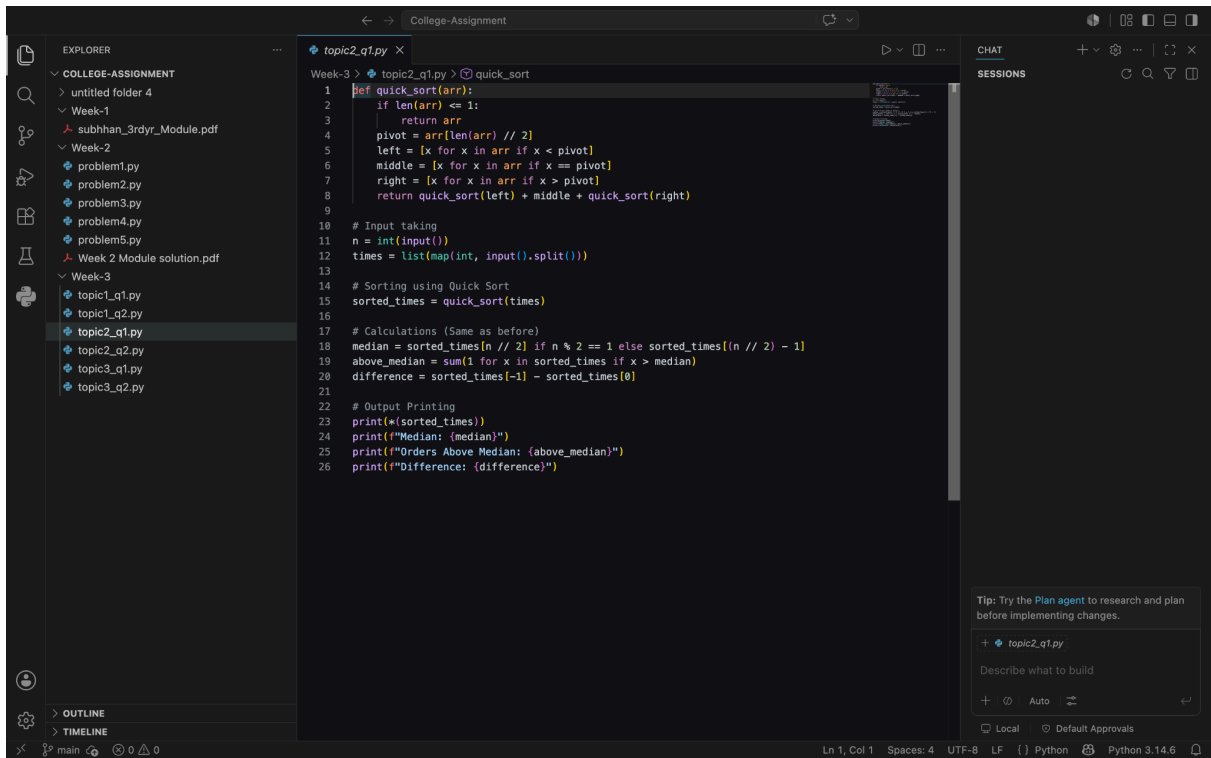
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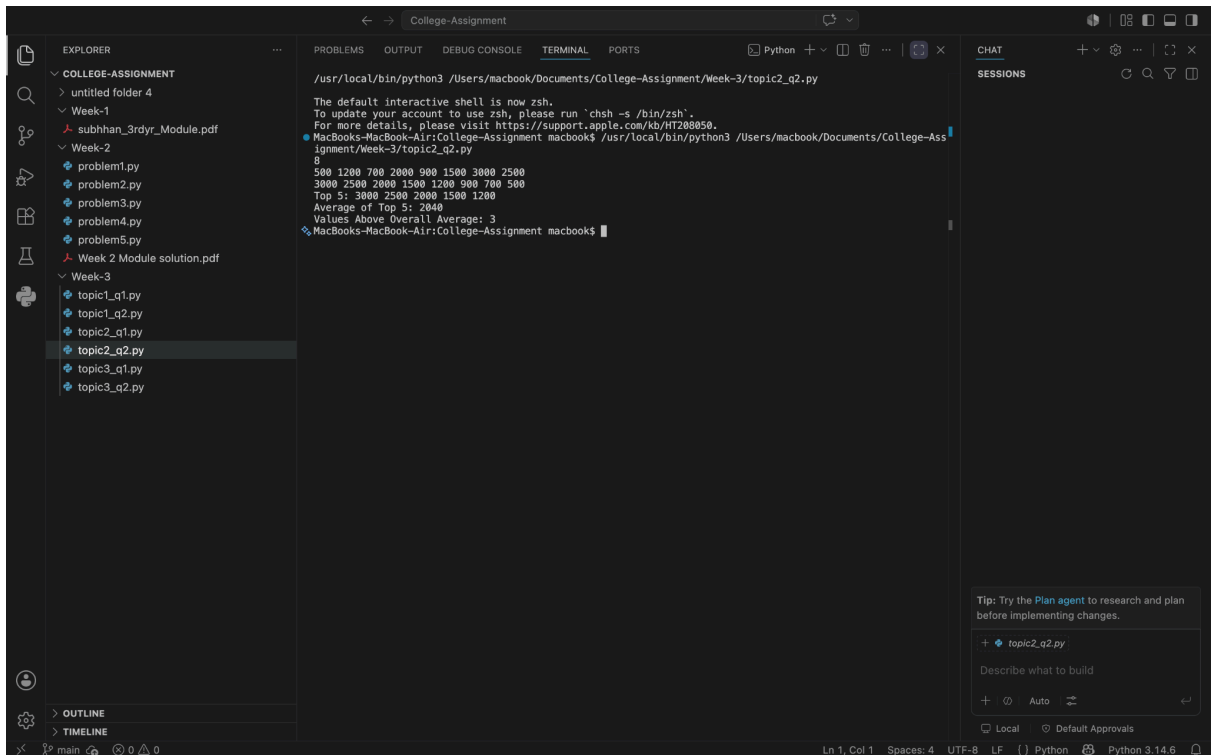
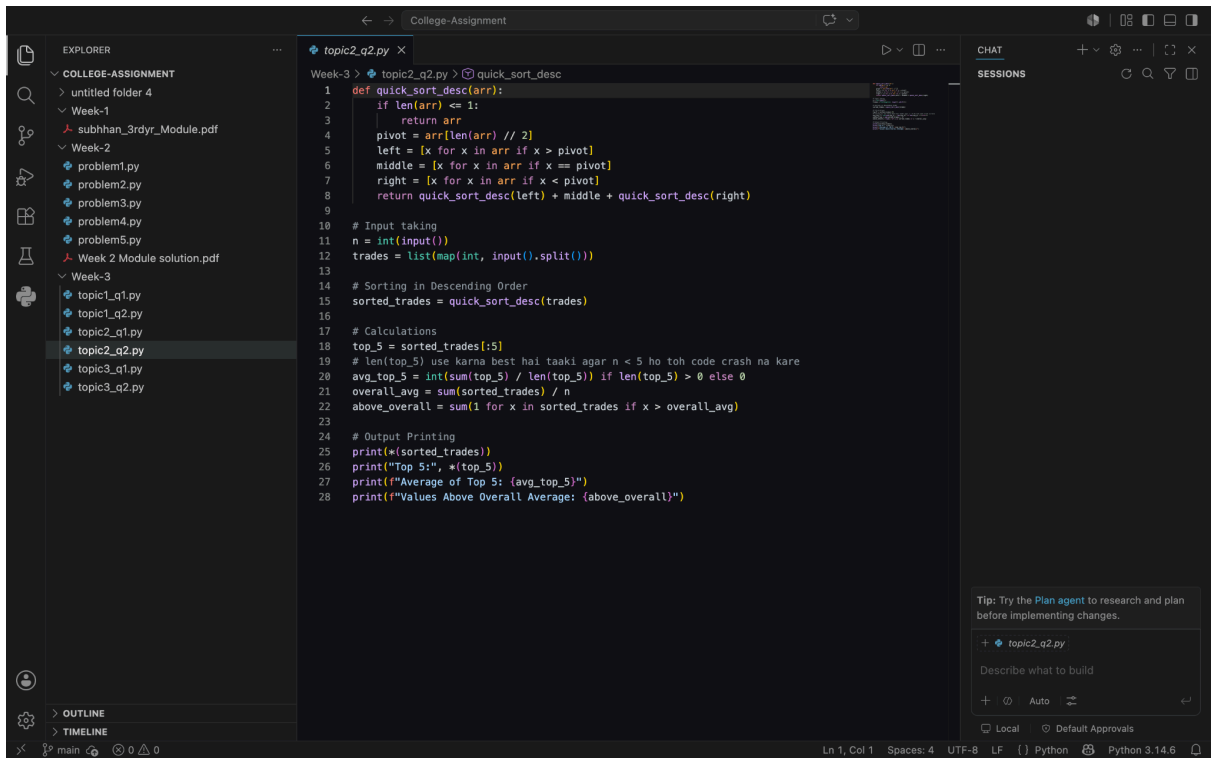
Question 2 (Medium): Stock Exchange Trade values Analysis

Problem - Financial data (trade data) must be analyzed in descending order (highest to lowest). We need to calculate the average of the top 5 trade and see how many total trade performed better than the overall market average.

How we changed Quick sort for descending order - In standard Quick sort, elements smaller than the pivot go to the left. To sort in descending order, we inverted the conditions: items greater than the pivot go into the left array, and items smaller go to the right array.

Code Reference - topic2-q2.py





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